



Storystick

Brand Guide

Storystick is a drawing tool for people who build things — a bookcase, a kitchen, a barn, an addition. This document defines how it looks, sounds, and holds together.

VERSION	ISSUED	OWNER	STATUS
1.0	August 2026	Rob Angevine	Foundational

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01 — THE NAME

Storystick

A **story stick** is the oldest planning tool there is: a length of scrap marked with every critical dimension of a job. Instead of re-reading a tape forty times and making forty chances to be wrong, you mark it once and carry the stick.

Storystick is that idea as software. Capture a dimension once, and it carries through every drawing, every elevation, every cut list — unchanged, unrounded, unmistakable.

The name also carries a second reading that matters. In building, a *story* is a level of a structure. And in the ordinary sense, every project has one: what it was, what it's becoming, what it took.

THE THREE READINGS

story stick

The marked layout stick. Precision carried, not remembered.

storey

A level of a building. The product spans furniture to floors.

story

What you're making, and why. The human half.

Written as one word, title case: **Storystick**. Never "Story Stick," "StoryStick," or "story-stick."

02 — POSITIONING

What Storystick is

Storystick is a design and drafting tool for people who build things. Precise enough for a permit set, simple enough for a Saturday project.

The gap it fills

Professional CAD is overbuilt and overpriced for a homeowner. Consumer room planners are toys the moment you need a real dimension. Storystick sits in the middle and scales in both directions.

The core promise

One model, many outputs. Draw it once and get the plan, the elevation, the section, the materials list, and the cut list — all in agreement, all the time.

What it is not

Not a rendering showroom. Not a BIM replacement. Not a project-management suite. Storystick draws and dimensions; it does not try to run your business.

BRAND PERSONALITY

Precise

Every number is real. Nothing is "about."

Plainspoken

Shop language over software language.

Unintimidating

Expertise is welcome. It is never required.

Made-by-hand

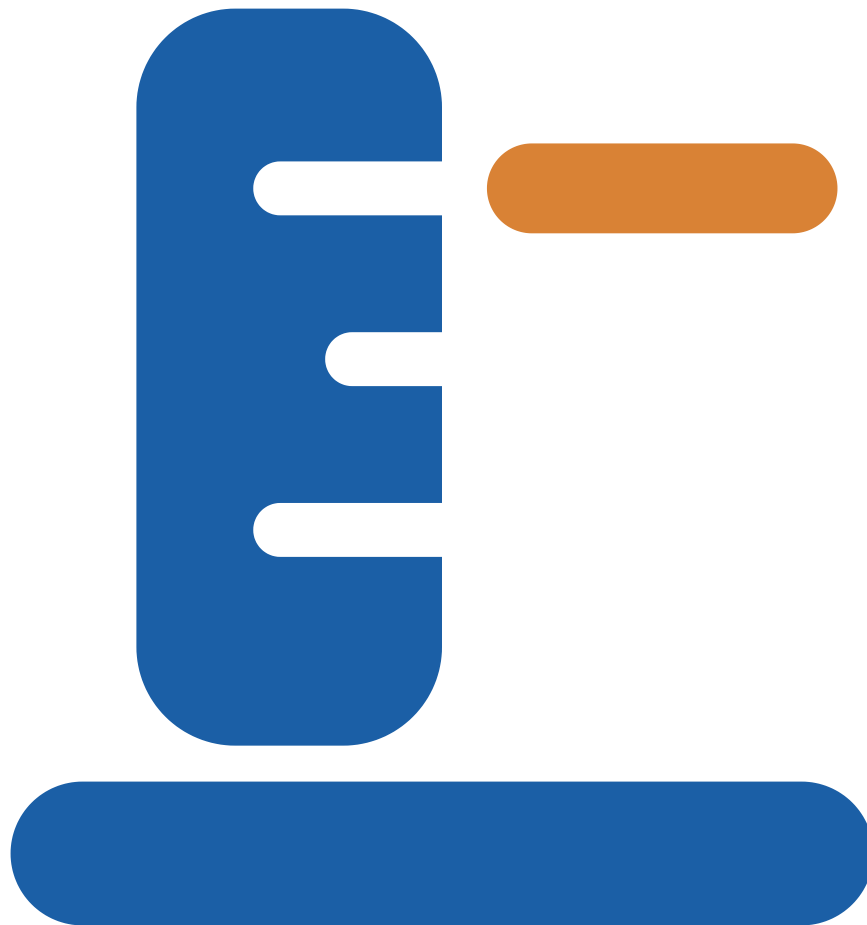
Digital tool, physical outcome. Never forget the sawdust.

Four users, one tool

The brand must read as credible to a licensed architect and as approachable to someone building their first bookshelf. That tension is the whole design problem — and the reason the system pairs drafting blue with a warm, human accent.

USER	COMES FOR	WHAT THE BRAND MUST SIGNAL
DIY & hobbyist woodworkers	Furniture, shop projects, jigs, cut lists	You will not be lost here. The tool speaks your language — kerf, rip, dado — not "parametric assembly."
Homeowners renovating	Kitchens, baths, additions, contractor conversations	You can produce something a professional will take seriously.
Contractors & remodelers	Field-ready drawings, quick as-builts, client sign-off	Fast, durable, readable on a phone in daylight. No fuss.
Architects & designers	Early schematic work, small residential, quick studies	The dimensions are trustworthy and the output is clean enough to hand over.

The mark



The mark is a **story pole standing on a floor line**. Three notches are cut into the pole — the marks you carry. One of them is transferred out to the right in cedar: the moment a measurement leaves the stick and becomes something you build to.

The notches are *knocked out*, not painted. The mark is a single-color shape plus one accent line, so it sits correctly on any background without a second version.

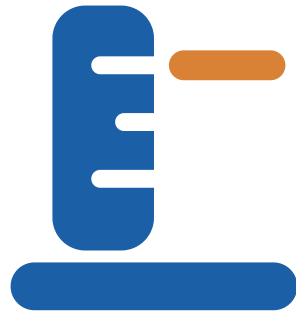
Geometry is built on a 120×120 grid with an 8-unit base module. Corner radii, stroke weights, and the notch depth are all multiples of it.

PRIMARY LOCKUPS



Storystick

HORIZONTAL — DEFAULT



Storystick

STACKED – SQUARE SPACES, AVATARS



Storystick

Draw it before you build it.

HORIZONTAL + TAGLINE – FIRST IMPRESSIONS

Storystick

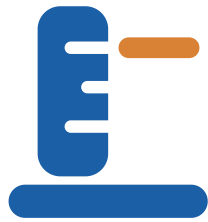
WORDMARK ALONE – WHEN THE MARK ALREADY APPEARS NEARBY

COLOR VARIANTS



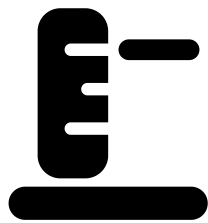
Storystick

REVERSE ON BLUEPRINT



Storystick

TWO-TONE — MARKETING ONLY



Storystick

ONE-COLOR BLACK — FAX, ENGRAVING, SINGLE-PLATE PRINT

The two-tone wordmark (Blueprint + Cedar) clarifies the compound word and is useful in campaign settings. It is **not** the default: product UI, documents, and partner marks use the single-color wordmark.

05 — CLEAR SPACE & SIZING

Give it room



MINIMUM CLEAR SPACE = X, THE WIDTH OF THE POLE IN THE MARK

Clear space

Define **X** as the width of the pole in the mark (34 units on the 120-unit grid — roughly 28% of the mark's height). Keep at least X of empty space on every side of any lockup.

Nothing crosses it: no type, no rules, no photo edges, no other logos.

Minimum sizes

ASSET	SCREEN	PRINT
Mark alone	16 px tall	5 mm
Horizontal lockup	104 px wide	26 mm
Stacked lockup	72 px wide	20 mm
Horizontal + tagline	180 px wide	44 mm

Below 20 px, use `favicon-mark` — a two-notch simplification drawn so the notches survive rasterization.

What not to do

The mark is simple, which makes it easy to break. These are the failures that actually happen.



DO Use the mark as drawn, in brand color, with the notches knocked out.



DON'T Don't recolor. The palette is the palette.



DON'T Don't stretch, squash, or scale non-proportionally.



DON'T Don't rotate. The pole is plumb and the line is level — that's the point.



DON'T Don't fill the notches with a third color. They are knockouts.



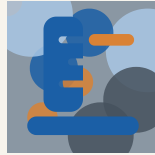
DON'T Don't add shadows, glows, bevels, or gradients.



DON'T Don't outline the mark. It is solid.



DON'T Don't detach the cedar line from the pole or change its position.



DON'T Don't set the mark on a busy field without a solid scrim behind it.

07 — COLOR

Blueprint and cedar

Two halves of one idea. The blues come from drafting — cyanotype paper, chalk lines, the cool light of a screen at 11pm. Cedar comes from the material side: sawdust, warm wood, a pencil behind the ear. Everything else is structure.

CORE

Blueprint

#0F2338 · 15 35 56

Primary dark. Canvas, headers, reverse fields, the app icon ground.



Drafting Blue

#1B5FA6 · 27 95 166

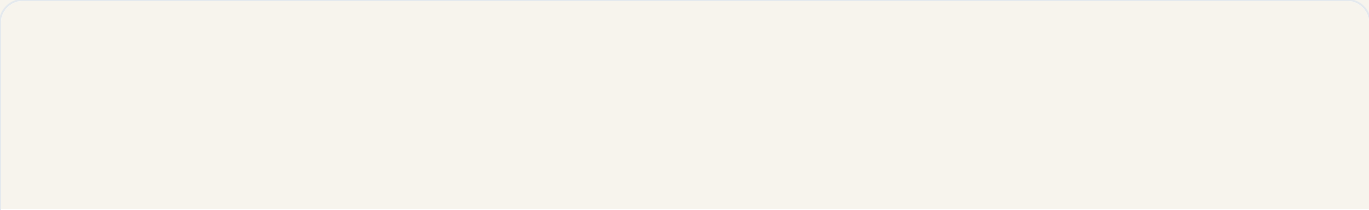
Primary brand. The mark, primary buttons, links, active tools.



Cedar

#D98235 · 217 130 53

The accent. The transfer line, selection, one CTA per screen. 5% of any layout.



Vellum

#F7F4ED · 247 244 237

Paper. The default light background — warmer than white, easier at length.

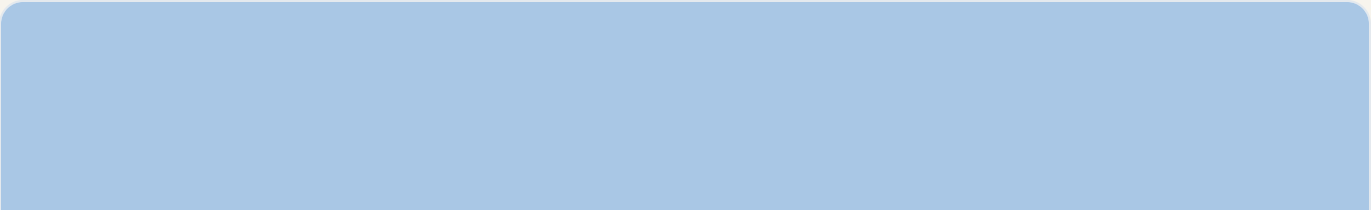
SUPPORT



Sky

#3E86CE · 62 134 206

Hover and focus on blue. Dimension lines on dark canvas.



Chalk

#A9C7E5 · 169 199 229

Blueprint line work, grid, secondary text on dark.



Ember

#EFA860 · 239 168 96

Cedar for dark backgrounds. 7.92:1 on Blueprint.



Cedar Deep

#9E5813 · 158 88 19

Cedar that can carry text on light. 4.95:1 on Vellum.



Graphite

#46525E · 70 82 94

Body copy on light. 7.27:1 on Vellum.



Slate

#65717C · 101 113 124

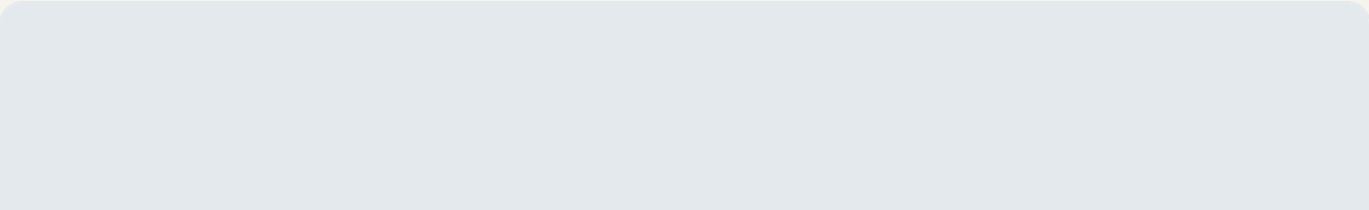
Secondary text, captions, labels. 4.54:1 on Vellum.



Slate 40

#8A97A3 · 138 151 163

Disabled states, placeholder text, decorative rules only.



Mist

#E4E9EE · 228 233 238

Borders, dividers, table rules, inactive fills.

FUNCTIONAL



Level Green

#1F9D6B · 31 157 107

Snapped, square, in tolerance. Shapes and icons on light.

Level Green Deep

#177C54 · 23 124 84

The text-safe green. 4.72:1 on Vellum.

Plumb Red

#D14343 · 209 67 67

Out of tolerance, conflict, destructive action.

Plumb Red Deep

#B93636 · 185 54 54

The text-safe red. 5.25:1 on Vellum.

BALANCE

Cedar is a spice, not a base. If a layout looks orange, it is wrong. The target mix for any full page or screen:

60% Vellum / Blueprint

25% Drafting Blue

10%
Neutral

5%

Cedar earns its 5% on: the accent line in the mark, the active/selected state, one key call to action per screen, and dimension callouts the user just created.

Contrast rules

Measured against WCAG 2.1. Normal text needs 4.5:1; large text (18.66 px bold or 24 px regular) and UI boundaries need 3:1.

FOREGROUND	BACKGROUND	RATIO	NORMAL TEXT	LARGE / UI
Blueprint #0F2338	Vellum	14.51:1	PASS	PASS
Graphite #46525E	Vellum	7.27:1	PASS	PASS
Slate #65717C	Vellum	4.54:1	PASS	PASS
Drafting Blue #1B5FA6	Vellum	5.91:1	PASS	PASS
Cedar #D98235	Vellum	2.66:1	FAIL	FAIL
Cedar Deep #9E5813	Vellum	4.95:1	PASS	PASS
Vellum #F7F4ED	Drafting Blue	5.91:1	PASS	PASS
Chalk #A9C7E5	Blueprint	9.1:1	PASS	PASS
Cedar #D98235	Blueprint	5.46:1	PASS	PASS
Ember #EFA860	Blueprint	7.92:1	PASS	PASS
Sky #3E86CE	Blueprint	4.18:1	FAIL	PASS
Chalk #A9C7E5	Canvas	10.02:1	PASS	PASS

Cedar is not a text color on light

Cedar #D98235 hits only 2.66:1 on Vellum. Use it for shapes, fills, lines, and icons — never for body copy on a light background. When cedar must carry text on light, use **Cedar Deep** #9E5813 (4.95:1).

On dark, cedar is fine

Cedar on Blueprint reaches 5.46:1 and passes for normal text. This is why the dark canvas is the natural home for cedar highlights — selection, active dimension, snap callouts.

Color is never the only signal. Snap states, errors, and validity always pair color with a shape, icon, or label change — a meaningful share of the woodworking and construction audience has some form of color vision deficiency, and job-site screens are read in direct sun.

09 — TYPOGRAPHY

Three faces, three jobs

BRAND & HEADLINES

Aa

Space Grotesk

Medium 500 / Bold 700. Geometric with just enough oddness to feel drawn rather than generated. The wordmark is Medium.

SIL OPEN FONT LICENSE 1.1

INTERFACE & BODY

Aa

Inter

Regular 400 → Bold 700. Neutral, tested at small sizes, excellent at 12–14 px where most of the app lives.

SIL OPEN FONT LICENSE 1.1

DIMENSIONS & DATA

Aa

IBM Plex Mono

Regular 400 / Medium 500. Every measurement, coordinate, cut-list entry, and part number. Fixed width means columns of numbers line up and a mis-keyed digit is visible.

SIL OPEN FONT LICENSE 1.1

THE RULE THAT MATTERS

If a number must be read exactly, it is set in IBM Plex Mono. If it is prose, it is Inter. No exceptions — this is the single typographic habit that makes Storystick feel like an instrument.

CUT LIST – SHELF UNIT / WALNUT

2	SIDE	72"	×	11-1/4"	×	3/4"
4	SHELF	33-1/2"	×	11"	×	3/4"
1	BACK	71-1/4"	×	34"	×	1/4"
– 3 board-feet waste at 1/8" kerf						

TYPE SCALE

Draw it before you build it.

DISPLAY SPACE GROTESK MEDIUM 64 / 66 / -3%

Plans for anything you build

H1 SPACE GROTESK MEDIUM 44 / 48 / -2.5%

Every build starts on the stick

H2 SPACE GROTESK MEDIUM 32 / 38 / -1.5%

Set the wall height

H3 SPACE GROTESK MEDIUM 21 / 28 / -1%

Capture a dimension once and it carries through every drawing.

BODY LARGE INTER REGULAR 18 / 30 / 0

Draw a wall, then set its height. Storystick keeps the cut list current.

BODY INTER REGULAR 16 / 26 / 0

Feet-and-inches or millimeters. Switch anytime.

SMALL INTER REGULAR 14 / 21 / 0

WALL HEIGHT

LABEL INTER SEMIBOLD 12 / 16 / +8%

96-1/4" × 33-1/2" × 3/4"

DIMENSION IBM PLEX MONO MEDIUM 13 / 18 / +1%

SKU 04-WAL-072 QTY 2 KERF 0.125

CODE / DATA IBM PLEX MONO REGULAR 12 / 20 / +1%

10 — APP ICON

On a home screen

Blueprint navy field, a whisper of grid at 9% chalk, the mark at 60% of the tile. The grid is the difference between an icon and a logo in a box — at a glance it reads as drafting paper.



Dark — primary



Light



Blue



Maskable / PWA



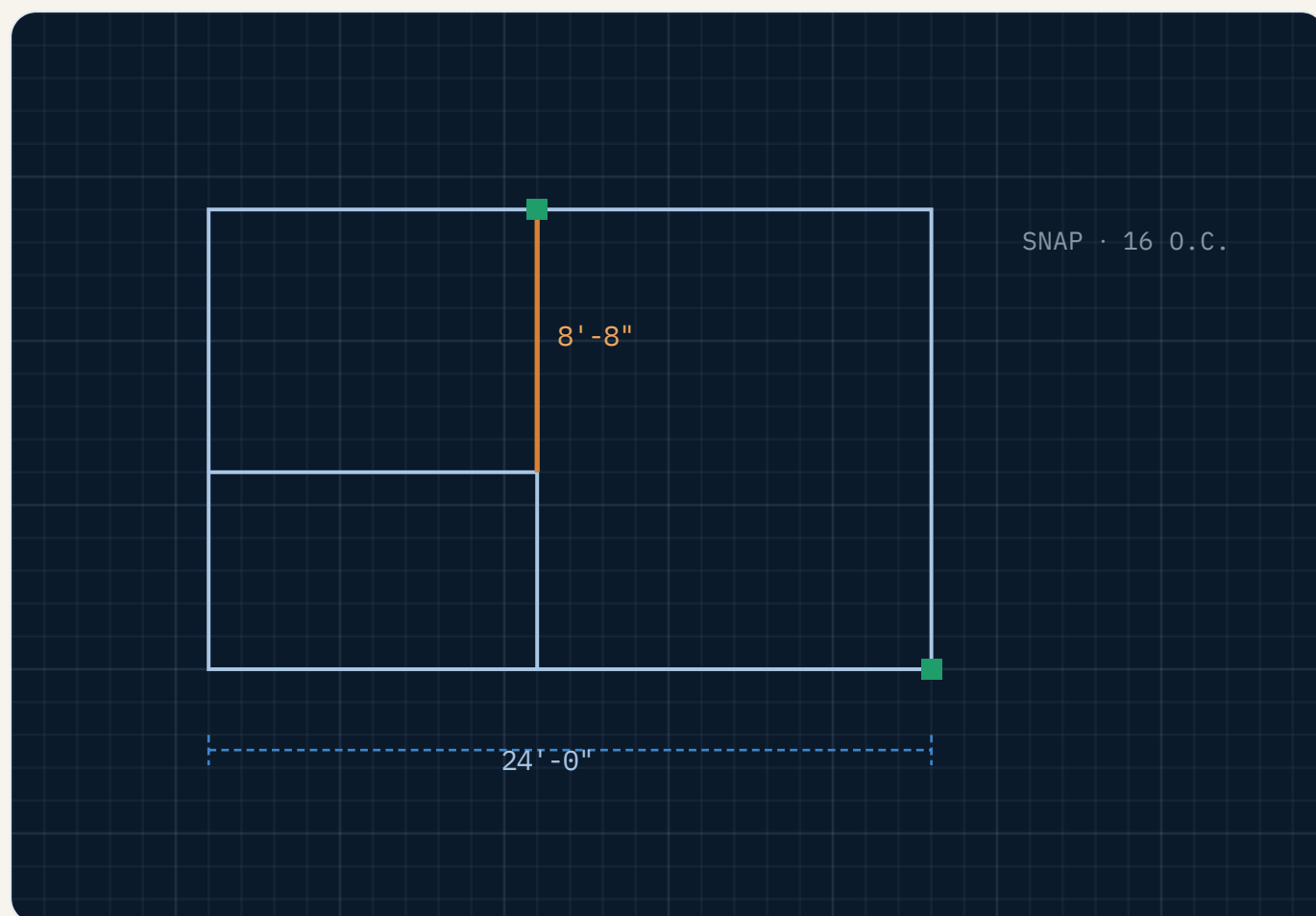
Favicon 32

Ship the maskable variant to Android and PWA manifests: it is full-bleed with the mark held inside the 80% safe circle, so aggressive platform masks never clip the pole. Below 24 px the three-notch mark collapses — the favicon build drops to two deeper notches.

11 — DRAWING LANGUAGE

How the canvas looks

The drawing surface is the product. Its conventions are part of the brand, not an afterthought of engineering.



BLUEPRINT MODE — THE DEFAULT WORKING CANVAS

ELEMENT

TREATMENT

Canvas

#0B1A2B

Minor grid	Chalk @ 6% · 1 px
Major grid	Chalk @ 12% · 1 px · every 5
Geometry	Chalk · 1.5 px
Selected	Cedar · 2 px
Dimension line	Sky · 1 px · 3-2 dash
Dimension text	Plex Mono 11 · Chalk
Snap indicator	Level Green · 6 px square
Out of tolerance	Plumb Red · 2 px + icon

A light **Paper mode** mirrors this on Vellum with Blueprint geometry, for printing and for outdoor screens. Both modes ship; neither is an afterthought.

LINE WEIGHT HIERARCHY

Storystick follows drafting convention rather than inventing one. Users who know it will feel at home; users who don't will absorb it without being taught.

WEIGHT	USED FOR
0.70 mm	Section cuts, walls in plan — anything the cutting plane passes through
0.50 mm	Object outlines in elevation, visible edges
0.35 mm	Surface lines, joinery, material changes
0.25 mm	Dimensions, leaders, hatching, centerlines
0.18 mm	Grid, construction geometry, hidden lines

How Storystick talks

Like a good shop teacher: knows more than you, never makes you feel it, tells you the number.

Use the trade's words

Kerf, rip, dado, stud bay, on-center, header, rise and run. Not "parametric assembly," "entity," or "workspace object." If a carpenter wouldn't say it on site, don't put it in the UI.

State the number

Never "approximately" when the value is known. "33-1/2 in." beats "about 33 and a half inches." Vagueness is the one thing this tool exists to eliminate.

Second person, active, present

"Draw a wall, then set its height." Not "Walls may be created and subsequently modified."

Errors name the fix

"This wall is 1/4 in. short of the corner — snap it?" Not "Invalid geometry." Every error message ends with something the user can press.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY

Draw it before you build it.

Your cut list updates as you draw.

That stud bay is 14-1/2 in. Want to snap it to 16 on-center?

Works in feet-and-inches or millimeters. Switch anytime.

Start with a wall.

NOT

~~Unleash your design potential.~~

~~Automatically generate a bill of materials.~~

~~Invalid geometry detected.~~

~~Full support for multiple unit systems and conversion workflows.~~

~~Get started by creating your first project workspace.~~

THINGS WE NEVER SAY

- **"Easy."** Building is not easy. Drawing it can be clearer, faster, and more certain — say that instead.
- **"Just."** As in "just drag the wall." It quietly blames the user when it doesn't work.
- **"Pro" as a slur or a gate.** The hobbyist is not a lesser user, and the architect is not a different species.
- **Anything implying the drawing is a substitute for a licensed professional** where one is legally required. Storystick produces drawings; it does not stamp them.

Taglines & boilerplate

PRIMARY TAGLINE

Draw it before you build it.

ALTERNATES

Every build starts on the stick.

Brand-led, for people who know the name's origin

From sketch to cut list.

Feature-led, woodworking channels

Plans for anything you make.

Broadest, app-store subtitle

Measure once. Draw it right.

Trade press, contractor channels

ONE-LINER

Storystick turns a rough idea into a real, dimensioned plan — for a bookshelf or a whole addition.

SHORT BOILERPLATE — 50 WORDS

Storystick is a design tool for people who build things. Draw a plan, an elevation, or a piece of furniture, and get accurate dimensions, materials, and cut lists that stay in agreement as you change your mind. Precise enough for a permit set, simple enough for a Saturday project.

APP-STORE SUBTITLE — 30 CHAR

Plans for anything you build

14 — ASSET INDEX

What's in the package

PATH

CONTENTS

logo/svg/

20 vector files — mark, wordmark, and every lockup in default, reverse, two-tone, and one-color black/white

logo/png/	Same set rasterized at 1× and 2×, transparent where applicable
icon/	App icon in dark, light, blue, and maskable builds — SVG plus PNG at 1024 / 512 / 256 / 192 / 180 / 120 / 96 / 64, and a two-notch favicon at 64 / 48 / 32 / 16
brand/	This guide, as HTML and PDF
ui/	Interface kit — tokens, components, both canvas modes, light and dark
gtm/	Landing page, app-store screenshot frames, social avatars and banners, OG image
fonts/	Space Grotesk, Inter, IBM Plex Mono — all SIL OFL 1.1, free for commercial use and embedding
tokens.json / tokens.css	Machine-readable color and type tokens for the build

Before you launch

- Run a US federal trademark search (USPTO TESS) in Class 9 and Class 42 for "Storystick" and near neighbors before you spend on print or file an application. This guide's name screening covered live products and domains, not registry records.
- Secure `storystick.app`, `storystick.com`, and the matching handles on the channels your audience actually uses — YouTube and Instagram carry disproportionate weight in woodworking.
- All three typefaces are SIL OFL 1.1: free to use, embed, and ship inside an application. Keep the license files with the fonts if you redistribute them.



Storystick

Brand Guide v1.0 · August 2026
Draw it before you build it.